Portrait of the Countess of Vergennes in Turkish Attire

The table known “Portrait of the Countess Vergennes in Turkish Attire” was brushed by Antoine Favray who has very important portraits of personalities of the Ottoman Empire.

Antoine Favray was born 1706 in France and died 1798 in Malta. Antoine Favray was painted this portrait table in 1766. This art has similar context with Charles Gravier because of the fact that Antoine Favray brushed two similar portrait for French Ambassador Charles Gravier and his wife. Antoine Favray cares on this art due to the fact that when Antoine Favray come to the İstanbul, Comte Vergennes took Antoine Favray under his protection. When he left the İstanbul, Vergennes entrusted Antoine Favray to new ambassador who is Saint Priest. This portrait made in İstanbul. This art was exhibited in different museum and in these days, it is in İstanbul Pera Museum with Orientalist Paintings Collection. Antoine Favray brushed his art on canvas with oil and it has w960 x h1290 cm for size. I took picture of this table in Pera Museum (Beyoğlu, İstanbul, Turkey). This amazing museum was founded in 8 June 2005 by Suna and İnan Kıraç Foundation to provide qualified and large scale cultural and artistic services. This museum exhibits collections of Orientalist Painting, Anatolian Weights and Measures and Kütahya Tiles and Ceramics and the values represented by these collections. All these collections belong to the Suna and İnan Kıraç Foundation. I got this information from here. This museum is so impressive place for people who care about art.

In this portrait artwork, we observe a woman dressed Turkish traditional attire and this model also has pearl jewelry on her arm, ear and head. If we focus on her dress, we face golden belt that has same color with her dress. Also, in this portrait there is a rosary with green fringe. This rosary shows that Turkish and Muslim tradition. This woman sits on armchair with fur. This shows that this woman has high social class. Vintilă-Ghiţulescu (2011) comment that clothes were therefore a social, political and economic indicator, revealing society's material and symbolic values (p.105). However, these portrait shows Ottoman traditional clothes with floral motif. This model has Turkish sitting style and she looks on her painters. She has dark background with green tones. This art is so important for

us because of the fact that an important foreign woman who is wife of ambassador wears Turkish traditional clothes and brushed her portrait with these clothes and jewels.

When looking at this art, the use of art elements used effectively by Antoine Favray. He uses green background to show portrait effectively. Because of the fact that portrait brushed in indoor, Antoine Favray uses dark color for background. Also, he puts horizontal line on portrait and her clothes. If we focus on portrait, there are shiny colors like yellow, pink, red and pearl white. Also, this portrait contains pearl jewelry on her arm, ear and head. These pearls attract attention on this work. If we care about clothes of model in portrait, her attire has floral motif which is pink or red on bright tones and this model has golden belt that is very salient. Antoine Favray gives efficient products for portrait art. When we focus on this art to understand principles and elements of this work, we face to a lot of critical points. First critical points in portrait is colors on the table because they attract attention. Antoine Favray use golden yellow, red, pink and pearl white in his art. Second critical point is background of the portrait of the countess. Antoine Favray puts dark green and bright green together in his work. This mean is that there is light games by Antoine Favray. Also, Antoine Favray uses horizontal and vertical lines on his table. If we focus on model, we can see these lines on her clothes. Another points is shape of portrait, it is needed to provide perfect order between model and all efficient color. If we focus on face of model, there is tones of pink, these tones used to put forward face of model. Also, thanks to the using dark green background, Antoine Favray gives three dimensional appearance. Last point of principles and design is using canvas for this work. It is efficient way to provide soft, dry and good physical structure. The style used by Antoine Favray is impression an 18th century art movement. Antoine Favray brushes a lot of portrait artwork that are perfect.

In this part, we discuss religion, politics, social structures and hierarchies, cultural practices and traditions, intellectual currents. We use history of ideas, materialism, feminism,

cultural studies and post-colonial theories to provide a method for this context part. When we care about this part, we can focus on this table because of the fact that every table or artwork have skills that is communication with people who see it. Understanding to conditions of period which artwork is created, we should understand what the painter wants to convey to us. We can do this by interpreting the visual language of the artist. When analyzing this artwork, we care the date and place of work of art should be taken consideration. It is brushed 18th century and in İstanbul, so we focus on this period of İstanbul and Turkey. When looking at the history of the Turkey in 18th century in terms of social and cultural cases. In this century, in many areas such as military, architecture, cultural activities, lifestyle, clothing Western samples are taken. Gocek (1987) says that the Ottoman reaction to another Western technological product, textiles, was different. When the Ottoman observed a large increase in Ottoman textile imports in the 18th century, they tried to reduce these imports (p.107). This shows us more imports cause westernization in terms of clothing. Despite of all these conditions in this artwork, a woman who is Western citizen wears a traditional clothes, this shows us there might be worry. Antoine Favray brushed this work so effectively. Also, we focus on social structure, in Ottoman Empire society was divided into two. Akyılmaz (1999) comment that one of the important points that gives the Ottoman Empire a different feature than its contemporary states is that the society is divided into two main social groups: the ruling class (bureaucracy) and the rayah (p.40). From the fur in the artwork behind model and the flamboyant armchair, we can see the class difference that occurred in the 18th century. Also, in the artwork there is a rosary, this shows religious thoughts in Ottoman Empire in 18th century.

Consequently, I believe that this artwork of Antoine Favray shows to people Turkish Tradition effectively because there are a lots of critical points to show people. Also, Antoine

Favray who is French painter is a famous person with his portrait artwork. Portrait of the Countess Vergennes in Turkish Attire is very helpful artwork in explaining the 18th century. When we focus on this amazing artwork, we can find some ideas of Ottoman Empire such as clothes, social class and religious areas.

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